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Teachers union criticized on images

Commission sees antisemitism in learning materials

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

The Massachusetts Teachers Association is under fire from a special state commission on antisemitism for distributing educational materials on the Israel-Hamas war that commissioners contend are antisemitic and offensive.

The Special Commission on Combatting Antisemitism gathered more than two dozen examples of MTA learning materials and other resources that its members said presented a one-sided view that favors Palestinians over Jews and Israelis. The materials intended for classroom use or to broaden educators' knowledge of the issues were posted on the members-only section of the MTA's website.

Among the materials: a replica of the Star of David made out of folded dollar bills, a poster featuring a hand grabbing the tongue of a snake that read "Unity in Confronting Zionism," another poster promoting the Free Palestine movement that read "Zionists [expletive] Off," and another poster seemingly depicting a Palestinian fighter with a rifle that warned, "What was taken by force can only be returned by force."

The MTA resources also included a storybook about a young Palestinian girl whose family had to flee their home because "a group of bullies called

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A new day for Red Sox



Dan Shaughnessy says the signing of Alex Bregman means everything is different

now for Red Sox Nation, which had been hoping for a big move. Alex Speier breaks down the \$120 million contract, and Peter Abraham analyzes where Bregman will fit best. **C1-3.**

Treasurer Deborah Goldberg said she fired Shannon O'Brien as the top cannabis regulator because she would "bully, humiliate, and abuse her colleagues," and made racially insensitive remarks. **B1.**

Hamas said it is ready to release Israeli hostages this weekend as laid out by the Gaza cease-fire agreement. **A3.**

It could soon cost more to ride Uber and Lyft to and from Logan as the Massachusetts Port Authority considers increasing fees the companies pay. **B5.**

Have a heart

Friday: Sunny, but a cold wind. High 32-37. Low 16-21.

Saturday: Snow, again. High 29-34. Low 23-28.

High tide: 12:13 a.m., 12:24 p.m.
Sunrise: 6:42 Sunset: 5:15

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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After promises, Kennedy confirmed

Republican senators confident in oversight; critics skeptical about his possible agenda

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Over and over again during his contentious process to get confirmed as federal health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr. found himself making promises.

To not interfere with the federal government's review and approval of

new vaccines. To not withhold funds appropriated by Congress for vaccination programs. To give Congress a remarkably high level of visibility and ongoing engagement in his administration of the country's most essential health programs.

In public hearings and private meetings, Kennedy made these com-

mitments — and many more — at the prompting of and to assuage the concerns of senators, particularly those with serious concerns about his views on vaccines and other issues. Virtually no previous nominee in recent memory to lead the Department of Health and Human Services has gone through such lengths to claim that they would not interfere with the basics of key public health programs in unprecedented ways.

Nevertheless, Kennedy's willing-

ness to make promises was perhaps the biggest factor in his successful confirmation, which broke largely along party lines on Thursday. Republican Senator Mitch McConnell of Kentucky, a polio survivor, joined Senate Democrats in voting against the nomination.

Senator Bill Cassidy, a Louisiana Republican, was seen as a make-or-break vote for Kennedy's confirmation; he announced his support in a Senate floor speech on Feb. 4 by listing

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ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES

Robert F. Kennedy Jr., accompanied by his wife, actress Cheryl Hines, was congratulated by President Trump after being sworn in Thursday.

Medical labs fear cuts would have huge impacts

By Robert Weisman, Kay Lazar, and Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

The anxiety — and the questions — began rippling through the vast network of academic medical labs in Massachusetts almost immediately.

After the National Institutes of Health issued an order last Friday night that would dramatically reduce funding, professor Venkatesh Murthy said four young researchers in his lab at Harvard University asked if they'll be able to continue their work.

"They're terrified of losing their jobs," said Murthy, director of the Center for Brain Science, whose own research focuses on the sense of smell. "The best I can say is: I will try my hardest to make sure they can keep doing their experiments. . . . But, unfortunately, at some point, it's not in my control."

Murthy's center stands to lose about \$8 million under a proposal by the Trump administration to cap the overhead expenses NIH will reimburse on top of medical research grants. These so-called indirect costs cover every-

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President Volodymyr Zelensky said Ukraine "will not be able to accept any agreements without us."

Courts stepping in

Judges are increasingly telling the Trump administration to stop, for now, what it's doing on a range of fronts. **A2.**

New role for McConnell

He's been the face of GOP resistance, pushing back against Trump's most controversial nominees. **A6.**

Attacking DOGE

Andrea Campbell and other attorneys general sued President Trump and Elon Musk for creating the agency. **B1.**

Trump clarifies Ukraine would be part of talks

By Jeanna Smialek, Zolan Kanno-Youngs, Matthew Mpoke Bigg, and Thomas Fuller
NEW YORK TIMES

BRUSSELS — President Trump on Thursday offered reassurances that Ukraine would be involved in negotiations to end the war with Russia, a day after his remarks left that prospect in doubt and alarmed officials in Kyiv and Ukraine's European allies that they would be left out of peace talks.

"Of course they would," Trump said in response to a reporter's question in the Oval Office in Washington about whether Ukraine would have a place at the table. "I mean, they're part of it. We would have Ukraine, we would have Russia, and we would have other people involved, too."

European leaders Thursday demanded a role in any discussions between Trump and President Vladimir Putin of Russia to end the conflict, negotiations that could set the terms of peace and redraw the map of Europe.

Some of the closest allies of the United States, including Britain and Germany, were among those

TRUMP, Page A6

Getting his story with more than just the 5 W's

Reporter becomes an internet star for a legacy news outlet

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The small town of Stow, "emotional ly in shambles" without a single Dunkin' shop, welcomes its first location in years. A guy known as "Krash the Krumper" is revealed as the mastermind behind Boston's best college dining hall pizza. The "legend" that played the video game Fortnite on the Fenway Park video scoreboard is unmasked.

Unless you're a regular on TikTok, you may have missed these stories. But they were some of the most widely viewed and shared in the New England news market last year — and they were all brought to life by reporter Matt Shearer, WBZ NewsRadio's unlikely internet star.

Shearer, 37, has racked up millions of views online for the more than 103-year-old station on TikTok and Instagram, platforms where news outlets have struggled mightily to gain ground. His account, @reportermatt, has over 83,000 followers on Instagram, and @wbznewsradio has north of 200,000

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PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF

Matt Shearer (right) was given his own action figure by Nick Lavallee. Shearer has helped introduce WBZ NewsRadio to a new, younger audience.